

Area of Shapes — Answer Key

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Part A — Rectangles & Squares

Problem 1 — Rectangle $5\text{ m} \times 6\text{ m}$

Multiply numbers AND units

Visual Count the 1 m^2 unit squares inside: 5 rows $\times$ 6 cols.

Math $5\text{ m} \times 6\text{ m} = 30\text{ m}^2$ (number: $5 \cdot 6 = 30$; unit: $\text{m} \cdot \text{m} = \text{m}^2$)

30 m²

Problem 2 — Rectangle $16\text{ yd} \times 9\text{ yd}$

Rectangle area

Math $16 \times 9 = 144$; $\text{yd} \times \text{yd} = \text{yd}^2$

144 yd²

Problem 3 — Rectangle $3.5\text{ cm} \times 8\text{ cm}$

Decimal $\times$ integer

Math $3.5 \times 8 = 28$; unit cm^2

28 cm²

Problem 4 — Square side 12 in

$s \times s = s^2$

Math $12 \times 12 = 144$; unit in^2

144 in²

Problem 5 — Square side $5\frac{1}{6}$ mm

Mixed-number square

Convert $5\frac{1}{6} = \frac{31}{6}$

Square $\left(\frac{31}{6}\right)^2 = \frac{961}{36}$

Mixed $961 \div 36 = 26 \text{ remainder } 25 \rightarrow 26\frac{25}{36}$

26 $\frac{25}{36}$ mm²

Part B — Triangles

Problem 6 — Triangle b=10 km, h=4 km

Half of a rectangle

Visual The triangle fills half of a 10×4 rectangle.

Math $\frac{10 \times 4}{2} = \frac{40}{2} = 20$; unit km²

20 km²

Problem 7 — Triangle b=9 in, h=5.2 in

Use perpendicular height (NOT slant)

Trap The 6 in is the slanted side — ignore it.

Math $\frac{9 \times 5.2}{2} = \frac{46.8}{2} = 23.4$; unit in²

23.4 in²

Problem 8 — Triangle b=11.6 km, h=6 km

Half of rectangle

Math $\frac{11.6 \times 6}{2} = \frac{69.6}{2} = 34.8$; unit km²

34.8 km²

Problem 9 — Triangle b=8 yd, h=5 yd

Math $\frac{8 \times 5}{2} = \frac{40}{2} = 20$; unit yd²

20 yd²

Part C — Parallelograms

Problem 10 — Parallelogram $b=9.7$ yd, $h=5$ yd

Parallelogram = rectangle in disguise

Visual Slice the slanted end, slide it across $\rightarrow 9.7 \times 5$ rectangle.

Math $9.7 \times 5 = 48.5$; unit yd^2 (the 5.8 yd slant is a distractor)

48.5 yd^2

Problem 11 — Parallelogram $b=12$ km, $h=8$ km

Math $12 \times 8 = 96$; unit km^2

96 km^2

Problem 12 — Parallelogram $b=8$ m, $h=6$ m

Math $8 \times 6 = 48$; unit m^2

48 m^2

Problem 13 — Parallelogram $b=14$ cm, $h=9$ cm

Math $14 \times 9 = 126$; unit cm^2

126 cm^2

Part D — Trapezoids

Problem 14 — Trapezoid $b_1=3$, $b_2=6$, $h=4$ (cm)

Two trapezoids $\rightarrow$ parallelogram

Visual Two of these make a 9×4 parallelogram = 36 cm^2 . One trapezoid = half.

Math $\frac{(3 + 6) \times 4}{2} = \frac{36}{2} = 18$; unit cm^2

18 cm^2

Problem 15 — Trapezoid $b_1=7$, $b_2=4$, $h=5$ (mm)

Math $\frac{(7 + 4) \times 5}{2} = \frac{55}{2} = 27.5$; unit mm^2

27.5 mm^2

Problem 16 — Trapezoid $b_1=6$, $b_2=3$, $h=3.9$ (m)

$$\text{Math } \frac{(6+3) \times 3.9}{2} = \frac{9 \times 3.9}{2} = \frac{35.1}{2} = 17.55; \text{ unit m}^2$$

17.55 m²

Problem 17 — Trapezoid $b_1=4$, $b_2=1$, $h=3.2$ (yd)

$$\text{Math } \frac{(4+1) \times 3.2}{2} = \frac{5 \times 3.2}{2} = \frac{16}{2} = 8; \text{ unit yd}^2$$

8 yd²

Problem 18 — Trapezoid $b_1=7$, $b_2=3\frac{1}{3}$, $h=4\frac{2}{3}$ (mm)

Mixed-number trapezoid

$$\text{Convert } b_2 = \frac{10}{3}, h = \frac{14}{3}, b_1 = 7 = \frac{21}{3}$$

$$\text{Sum } b_1 + b_2 = \frac{21}{3} + \frac{10}{3} = \frac{31}{3}$$

$$\text{Times h } \frac{31}{3} \times \frac{14}{3} = \frac{434}{9}$$

$$\text{Half } \frac{434}{9} \div 2 = \frac{434}{18} = \frac{217}{9} = 24\frac{1}{9}$$

24 1/9 mm²

Part E — Word Problems**Problem 19 — Trapezoid: area = 96 cm², $h = 6$ cm, $b_2 = b_1 + 4$. Find b_1 , b_2 .**

Reverse the formula

$$\text{Setup } \frac{(b_1 + b_2) \times 6}{2} = 96 \Rightarrow (b_1 + b_2) \times 3 = 96$$

$$\text{Solve } b_1 + b_2 = 32$$

$$\text{Substitute } b_1 + (b_1 + 4) = 32 \Rightarrow 2b_1 = 28 \Rightarrow b_1 = 14$$

$$\text{Therefore } b_2 = 14 + 4 = 18$$

$b_1 = 14$ cm, $b_2 = 18$ cm

Problem 20 — Parallelogram floor 14 m $\times$ 5 m

Parallelogram = rectangle

$$\text{Math } 14 \times 5 = 70; \text{ unit m}^2$$

70 m² of carpet